

Part A: *Pax*, Chapter 4 — Reading Comprehension

Circle the letter of the best answer for the multiple-choice items. Answer the rest in complete sentences.

1. What does Peter call “the first mistake of the trip”?
 - A. Leaving without telling his grandfather
 - B. Not hunting for his grandfather’s flashlight
 - C. Packing only one extra pair of socks
 - D. Not paying attention while driving with his father
2. Describe how Peter used the garbage bags. What does this show about him?
3. About how far has Peter traveled, and how much farther must he go to reach the highway?
 - A. Two or three miles so far; ten more to go
 - B. Twelve miles so far; five more to go
 - C. Seven or eight miles so far; twenty more to go
 - D. Twenty miles so far; seven or eight more to go
4. Why isn’t Peter in a complete panic about being chased yet? What does he believe about his grandfather’s schedule?
5. What does Peter see in the hardware store window, and how does it change his mood?
 - A. His own reflection, looking like an unprepared runaway; his hopeful mood melts
 - B. A police officer watching him from inside; he panics and runs
 - C. A display of flashlights he cannot afford; he feels discouraged
 - D. A missing-person poster with his face on it; he feels hunted
6. The author compares the man in the blue jacket to a hawk. What does this comparison suggest about how Peter sees him?
7. Why does Peter tell the man, “Lunch break. Got to hurry back”?
 - A. He is genuinely hungry and wants to buy food
 - B. To hurry the man into selling him a flashlight
 - C. To convince the man he has a job nearby
 - D. To explain why he is not in school on a weekday
8. Peter says he doesn’t think he believes in signs, “but after the coyotes last night, he wasn’t sure he didn’t.” What does this reveal about how Peter is changing?

9. Peter thinks Pax “would have chosen this same spot—protected, but with a good vantage point.” Why does the author include this thought right here?
10. Peter promises himself, “Just an hour. I won’t even close my eyes.” Based on how the chapter ends, what is the author setting up?

Part B: *Pax*, Chapter 5 — Reading Comprehension

Circle the letter of the best answer for the multiple-choice items. Answer the rest in complete sentences.

11. What are the vixen’s first words to Pax, and what does her posture tell him she expects?
- A. “This is my territory” — ears and tail erect, expecting his submission
 - B. “Where is your boy?” — ears flat, showing her fear of him
 - C. “You are welcome here” — tail low, showing friendliness
 - D. “I am hungry” — teeth bared, ready to attack him
12. Why doesn’t Pax react to the strange vixen the way a wild fox would? Use the detail about his age when Peter found him.
13. What is the very first thing Pax wants to ask the vixen about? What does this tell you about his priorities?
14. What does Bristle do immediately after she springs and dives into the grass?
- A. She carries the rat back to her den untouched
 - B. She bites through the rat’s neck, then drops it to the ground
 - C. She offers the rat to Pax as a greeting
 - D. She buries the rat to save it for later
15. Pax has never eaten raw prey. When he gets hungry he thinks of his kibble bowl and Peter’s hand-fed treats — and one food he calls “the ultimate reward.” What is it?
- A. Chicken scraps
 - B. Scrambled eggs
 - C. Cheese
 - D. Peanut butter

16. When Bristle walks away with the rat, what memory does it trigger in Pax? Why is that memory so painful?
17. Who is Runt, and how does his reaction to Pax differ from his sister's?
18. Pax is amazed watching Runt leap. What is the highest Pax himself has ever climbed?
- A. He has never climbed anything at all
 - B. Twelve feet — the trunk of a fallen oak
 - C. Six feet — the walls of his pen
 - D. The roof of his humans' house
19. Bristle sends her brother an image as a warning. Describe what is in that image and explain what really happened to those two foxes.
20. Bristle finally allows Pax to come along, but with a condition. What is the condition, what does she call him, and what does Pax privately promise himself at the end of the chapter?

Part C: *Pax*, Chapter 6 — Reading Comprehension

Circle the letter of the best answer for the multiple-choice items. Answer the rest in complete sentences.

21. What sounds wake Peter up, and why is he “too late”?
- A. A police siren; an officer has already spotted him
 - B. Kids' footfalls, hoots, and fists thumping into gloves; twenty boys and their coach are already streaming down the hill
 - C. A groundskeeper's mower; the field is being closed for the day
 - D. Thunder; the storm has already soaked his pack
22. Which description matches the shortstop Peter picks out to watch?
- A. A tall boy in a gray uniform who shouts constantly
 - B. A boy with black curled hair, the coach's own son
 - C. A heavyset boy playing first base who misses easy throws
 - D. **D** — A small kid with a straw-colored crew cut and a bleached-out red T-shirt, who stands like

a statue until the bat connects

23. Which two words does Peter use when he tries to describe the feeling he gets on a baseball field?
- A. “Quiet” and “safe”
 - B. “Sharp” and “clear”
 - C. “Holy” and “calm”
 - D. “Free” and “light”
24. What does Peter love even more than his territory on the field, and what does the fence do for him? How does he wish life off the field worked?
25. Describe what Peter did during his therapy sessions, and what the therapist said to him every single time.
26. At the last session the therapist asks Peter if he feels angry. What does he answer, and what does the narrator immediately tell us?
- A. He admits he is furious; the narrator says he felt relieved
 - B. He says “No... Never”; the narrator says flatly, “A lie”
 - C. He refuses to answer and walks out; the narrator says he never returned
 - D. He says he is only sad; the narrator says the therapist believed him
27. What secret fear does Peter have about the day his mother died? Why does this explain so much about his behavior?
28. Explain how Peter found Pax. What was he originally trying to do, and what did he find in the den?
29. Peter lies to the shortstop about being from Hampton. Why does he lie, why does the boy call him a jerk, and why does Peter still feel “lousy” afterward?

30. The chapter ends with the line “He couldn’t walk.” Trace the chain of events that leads to this moment, and explain why it is such a serious problem for Peter *and* for Pax.

Part D: Parts of Speech

Identify the part of speech of the **bolded** word: *noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, or conjunction.*

1. The archaeologist **carefully** brushed dirt from the pottery shard. _____
2. A thick fog rolled **across** the harbor before dawn. _____
3. **Marisol** repaired the bicycle chain in under ten minutes. _____
4. The soup tasted **salty**, but nobody complained. _____
5. Trevor wanted to go, **but** his sister had the car. _____
6. **She** volunteered at the animal shelter every Saturday. _____
7. The glacier **retreated** nearly a mile in one decade. _____
8. We waited **patiently** while the technician rebooted the server. _____
9. The key was hidden **beneath** a loose floorboard. _____
10. Our team won the championship, **and** the crowd erupted. _____
11. That **antique** clock chimes on the hour. _____
12. The pilot announced **their** arrival time over the intercom. _____
13. Wildfires threatened the **canyon** for three straight weeks. _____
14. The kitten **darted** under the porch. _____
15. Snow fell **steadily** throughout the night. _____
16. Put the ladder **against** the wall. _____
17. **Neither** the coach nor the players expected the upset. _____
18. A **brilliant** flash lit the sky above the ridge. _____
19. The chemist labeled every **beaker** on the counter. _____
20. Nobody claimed the wallet, **so** the clerk turned it in. _____
21. Amara **rarely** misses a rehearsal. _____
22. The trail winds **through** a grove of redwoods. _____
23. They **built** the treehouse without a single nail. _____
24. **Everyone** in the choir sang the final verse. _____
25. The **wooden** bridge groaned under the truck's weight. _____
26. Please water the plants **or** ask a neighbor to do it. _____
27. The comet will be visible **tomorrow**. _____
28. Dr. Osei studies bacteria that survive **inside** volcanic vents. _____
29. My grandmother **knits** scarves for the shelter. _____
30. The referee gave **us** one final warning. _____

Extra credit — same word, two different jobs:

31. The company will **ship** the order on Friday. _____
32. A cargo **ship** entered the narrow channel. _____

Part E: Subject, Predicate, Simple Subject, Simple Predicate

For each sentence write (a) the complete subject, (b) the complete predicate, (c) the simple subject, and (d) the simple predicate.

1. The rusty gate at the end of the lane creaked loudly.
2. My older brother and his roommate cooked dinner.
3. Down the hill rolled the runaway barrel.
4. A cracked window let cold air into the classroom.
5. Several exhausted hikers rested near the waterfall.
6. The orchestra rehearsed and then performed the symphony.
7. In the corner of the attic sat a dusty trunk.
8. Ms. Ferrand's chemistry students designed their own experiments.
9. My neighbors repaint their fence every spring.

10. A flock of geese crossed the highway slowly.
11. Neither the mayor nor the council members attended.
12. Through the fog appeared a single lantern.
13. The old lighthouse keeper polished the enormous lens every morning.
14. My cousin writes poetry and paints watercolors.
15. Across the lake drifted a wooden canoe.
16. Two enormous oak trees shade the entire yard.
17. Beneath the floorboards scurried a family of mice.
18. The referee and the coach argued for ten minutes.
19. Fresh bread from the corner bakery smells wonderful.

20. The librarian and her assistant reorganized the entire shelf.

21. A sudden gust of wind slammed the door.

22. The astronauts trained for eighteen months.

23. Behind the barn stood an abandoned tractor.

24. Jamal and Priya organized the fundraiser together.

25. The nervous contestant stumbled over her opening line.

26. The mechanic inspected the brakes and replaced the filter.

27. The engine sputtered, coughed, and finally died.

28. Above the treeline circled a lone hawk.

29. Every member of the debate team received a medal.

30. My grandfather's antique pocket watch still keeps perfect time.

Part F: Subject-Verb Agreement

Circle the correct verb.

1. The box of old photographs (is / are) in the closet.
2. Everyone in the classes (was / were) surprised by the announcement.
3. Neither the twins nor their mother (drive / drives) to work.
4. There (is / are) three reasons for the delay.
5. Mathematics (require / requires) daily practice.
6. Both of the candidates (has / have) agreed to debate.
7. The committee (meet / meets) on the first Tuesday of each month.
8. Here (come / comes) the parade floats.
9. Each of the students (need / needs) a permission slip.
10. Neither the coach nor the players (was / were) ready.
11. Twenty dollars (seem / seems) like a fair price.
12. The news from the mountains (is / are) encouraging.
13. Where (is / are) my keys?
14. Some of the cake (was / were) left on the counter.
15. Some of the cookies (was / were) left on the counter.
16. My best friend and mentor (is / are) retiring this spring.
17. A stack of pancakes (sit / sits) on the table.
18. Few of the applicants (meet / meets) every requirement.
19. *Great Expectations* (remain / remains) my favorite novel.
20. The jury (disagree / disagrees) about the verdict among themselves.
21. Either the manager or her assistants (handle / handles) refunds.
22. None of the water (has / have) been tested.

Each sentence below has one agreement error. Find it and rewrite the sentence correctly.

23. The bouquet of yellow roses were sitting on the piano.
24. Every one of the tickets have already been sold.
25. There is many opportunities for volunteers this summer.
26. Physics are the hardest class on my schedule.

27. Neither the librarian nor the volunteers knows the passcode.

28. My uncle and my aunt lives in Vermont.

29. Here lies the answers to yesterday's puzzle.

30. Half of the pizza were eaten before I arrived.

Answer Key

Part A: *Pax*, Chapter 4

1. **B** — Not hunting for his grandfather's flashlight. Without it, the moon lit his way only about two hours before it drowned beneath thick clouds; he stumbled in the dark another hour before giving up, losing most of a night's travel.
2. He slit one open into a long mat to lie on and cut the other into a poncho against the cold mist, using his mitt as a pillow. He is resourceful, but he is improvising because he packed badly.
3. **C** — Maybe seven or eight miles so far; about twenty more miles before the highway.
4. His grandfather won't be home from work for a whole day, so no one will even suspect he is gone yet.
5. **A** — His reflection — hair tangled with leaves, sweatshirt streaked in mud, nose reddening toward a full-faced sunburn. "The kid in the window looked like a runaway—one who hadn't prepared very well." His hopeful mood melts.
6. The man peers down his nose the way a hawk Peter once saw searched for prey from the top of a cedar. Peter feels hunted — like small prey being watched by a predator.
7. **D** — He is covering for why he isn't in school. It only half works: the man nods, but then follows him inside, hovers while he shops, shadows him at checkout, and follows him outside to point him toward the school.
8. He is becoming more superstitious and more willing to trust feelings over logic; fear and exhaustion are wearing down his usual practical thinking.
9. It shows Pax is constantly on Peter's mind — he understands the world by imagining what his fox would do. It also quietly justifies the risky decision to stop and rest.
10. He is far more exhausted than he admits. The promise sounds like reassurance but signals that he *will* fall asleep and lose time — exactly what happens in Chapter 6, where he loses over three hours.

Part B: *Pax*, Chapter 5

11. **A** — "This is my territory," followed by "I hunt here." Ears and tail held erect mean she expects his submission.
12. He was orphaned and rescued by Peter at only sixteen days old, his eyes barely opened. He was born with the same instinct to distrust, but "distrust is no match for kindness administered consistently and unmeasured," so he approaches instead of fleeing.
13. Whether she has seen his boy — he shares images of Peter's round ears, impossibly long legs, and black curled hair. Finding Peter matters more to him than territory, food, or safety.
14. **B** — Her ears prick at a rustling in broom sedge, her rear twitches gathering energy, she springs high with paws tight over her black nose, dives into the grass, comes up with the rat in her jaws, and bites through its neck. She is a competent wild hunter; Pax, raised in a pen, has never even eaten raw prey.
15. **D** — His brimming kibble bowl, Peter's hand-fed treats, and the ultimate reward: peanut butter. He concludes he needs to find his boy, because "his boy would feed him."
16. The memory of his humans' car roaring away in its stinging spray of gravel. It is the moment he was abandoned, so any creature leaving him now reopens that wound.
17. Runt is Bristle's smaller, skinnier brother — "brother but not littermate." He announces *Friendly...* *Play!* and welcomes Pax "as though they had played together since birth," while Bristle bares her teeth and warns *Dangerous. Stay away.*
18. **C** — He has climbed the walls of his pen, but never higher than six feet. It shows how limited his life has been — he didn't even know foxes could "soar like birds."
19. A cold, howling wind; a mated pair of foxes struggling with something like steel but with jaws and

clamps instead of bars; the steel jaws and snowy ground smeared with blood. They were caught in human traps — the source of Bristle’s hatred and fear of humans.

20. “One night only, Human-Stinker.” He may shelter with them only for the storm. Pax privately promises that he will follow his scent back to the road after the storm, that his humans will come for him, and that once he finds his boy he will never leave his side.

Part C: *Pax*, Chapter 6

21. **B** — The footfalls of just-released kids, their hoots, and fists thumping into gloves. He is too late because twenty boys and their coach are already streaming down the hill and uniformed adults are up at the parking lot, so he cannot slip away unseen and must blend in on the bleachers.
22. A small kid with a straw-colored crew cut and a bleached-out red T-shirt, playing shortstop. While everyone else scrambles “like puppies,” he stands like a statue, hands poised waist high, eyes glued to the bat, and springs the instant “wood smacked cowhide.” He reaches every ball near his territory despite being short enough to look like someone’s tag-along kid brother.
23. **C** — “Holy” came the closest and “calm” was in the mix, but neither was exactly right. It feels too private, and he doesn’t think he has the words to explain it.
24. The fence behind his territory. It tells him exactly what is his responsibility and what isn’t — inside the fence he’d better field it; over the fence isn’t his to worry about. “Nice and clear.” He wishes responsibility had such bright tall fences around it off the field, too.
25. He pulled little cars and trucks from a toy box (there must have been a hundred) and crashed them together, two by two. Every time she said: “That must have been hard for you. Your mom gets in a car to go buy groceries, a regular day, and she never comes home.”
26. **B** — “No... Never.” The narrator says flatly: “A lie.”
27. That he had done something terrible, and that as punishment his mother hadn’t taken him to the store — and that she blamed him for what happened. He secretly believes her death was his fault, which explains his buried anger, his guilt, and his desperate need to protect Pax.
28. He found a fox run over by the side of the road near his house. So soon after his mother’s coffin was lowered into the ground, he felt an unshakable need to bury the body. Looking for a good place, he found the den with three cold, stiff kit bodies and one little ball of gray fur still warm and breathing. He tucked Pax into his sweatshirt pocket and told his dad — *said*, not asked — “I’m keeping him.”
29. He lies to cover his runaway tracks and hide where he is really going. The boy assumes he is scouting before Saturday’s game, so he spits and calls him a jerk. Peter feels lousy because he had just done something kind — staying to help a kid the team abandoned — and his lie destroyed a genuine connection with someone who understood the same “holy calm” he feels.
30. He wastes over three hours sleeping; leaving the field at 4:15, he hurries through town, scales a fence, reaches the highway at about 4:50, crosses it, and takes a dirt wagon road that turns out to lead to someone’s barn instead of a shortcut. He rests, eats, watches fourteen deer, and is startled off when a saw screeches. Fleeing the headlights on the highway, he ducks into spongy peat ground, sinks his foot into swamp water (soaking his boots — “another mistake”), and while clambering back to higher ground his right foot catches on a root. He hears the bone break, a soft muffled snap. It is catastrophic because his whole plan depends on walking roughly twenty more miles to Pax — and Pax, who has never eaten raw prey and is waiting by the road for humans who aren’t coming, has no one else.

Part D: Parts of Speech

- | | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. adverb | 12. pronoun | 23. verb |
| 2. preposition | 13. noun | 24. pronoun |
| 3. noun | 14. verb | 25. adjective |
| 4. adjective | 15. adverb | 26. conjunction |
| 5. conjunction | 16. preposition | 27. adverb |
| 6. pronoun | 17. conjunction | 28. preposition |
| 7. verb | 18. adjective | 29. verb |
| 8. adverb | 19. noun | 30. pronoun |
| 9. preposition | 20. conjunction | 31. verb |
| 10. conjunction | 21. adverb | 32. noun |
| 11. adjective | 22. preposition | |

Notes: 17 *Neither* is part of the correlative pair *neither...nor*. 24 *Everyone* is an indefinite pronoun. 27 *tomorrow* is an adverb here because it tells *when*. 31–32 show *ship* as verb, then noun.

Part E: Subject, Predicate, Simple Subject, Simple Predicate

Format: (a) complete subject | (b) complete predicate | (c) simple subject | (d) simple predicate

- The rusty gate at the end of the lane | creaked loudly | gate | creaked
- My older brother and his roommate | cooked dinner | brother, roommate (compound) | cooked
- the runaway barrel | Down the hill rolled | barrel | rolled
- A cracked window | let cold air into the classroom | window | let
- Several exhausted hikers | rested near the waterfall | hikers | rested
- The orchestra | rehearsed and then performed the symphony | orchestra | rehearsed, performed (compound)
- a dusty trunk | In the corner of the attic sat | trunk | sat
- Ms. Ferrand's chemistry students | designed their own experiments | students | designed
- My neighbors | repaint their fence every spring | neighbors | repaint
- A flock of geese | crossed the highway slowly | flock | crossed
- Neither the mayor nor the council members | attended | mayor, members (compound) | attended
- a single lantern | Through the fog appeared | lantern | appeared
- The old lighthouse keeper | polished the enormous lens every morning | keeper | polished
- My cousin | writes poetry and paints watercolors | cousin | writes, paints (compound)
- a wooden canoe | Across the lake drifted | canoe | drifted
- Two enormous oak trees | shade the entire yard | trees | shade
- a family of mice | Beneath the floorboards scurried | family | scurried
- The referee and the coach | argued for ten minutes | referee, coach (compound) | argued
- Fresh bread from the corner bakery | smells wonderful | bread | smells
- The librarian and her assistant | reorganized the entire shelf | librarian, assistant (compound) | reorganized
- A sudden gust of wind | slammed the door | gust | slammed
- The astronauts | trained for eighteen months | astronauts | trained
- an abandoned tractor | Behind the barn stood | tractor | stood
- Jamal and Priya | organized the fundraiser together | Jamal, Priya (compound) | organized
- The nervous contestant | stumbled over her opening line | contestant | stumbled
- The mechanic | inspected the brakes and replaced the filter | mechanic | inspected, replaced (compound)
- The engine | sputtered, coughed, and finally died | engine | sputtered, coughed, died (compound)

28. a lone hawk | Above the treeline circled | hawk | circled
29. Every member of the debate team | received a medal | member | received
30. My grandfather's antique pocket watch | still keeps perfect time | watch | keeps

Part F: Subject-Verb Agreement

1. is — subject is *box*
2. was — *everyone* is singular
3. drives — *nor* makes the verb agree with *mother*
4. are — subject is *reasons*
5. requires — *mathematics* is singular
6. have — *both* is plural
7. meets — collective noun acting as one unit
8. come — subject is *floats*
9. needs — *each* is singular
10. were — verb agrees with *players*
11. seems — an amount treated as one sum
12. is — *news* is singular
13. are — subject is *keys*
14. was — *some* with the singular mass noun *cake*
15. were — *some* with the plural *cookies*
16. is — one person holding two roles
17. sits — subject is *stack*
18. meet — *few* is plural
19. remains — a title is singular
20. disagree — members acting individually (“among themselves”)
21. handle — verb agrees with *assistants*
22. has — *none* with the singular mass noun *water*
23. The bouquet of yellow roses **was** sitting on the piano.
24. Every one of the tickets **has** already been sold.
25. There **are** many opportunities for volunteers this summer.
26. Physics **is** the hardest class on my schedule.
27. Neither the librarian nor the volunteers **know** the passcode.
28. My uncle and my aunt **live** in Vermont.
29. Here **lie** the answers to yesterday's puzzle.
30. Half of the pizza **was** eaten before I arrived.